

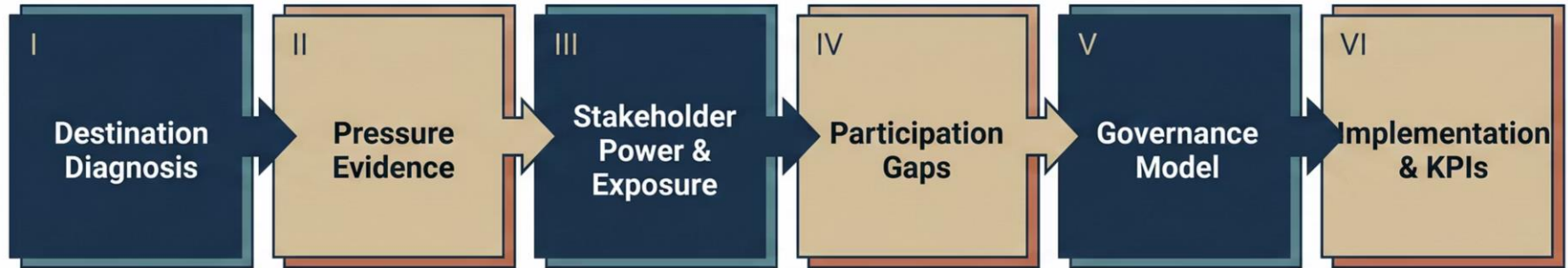
From Tourism Pressure to Participatory Governance

A Stakeholder-Based Sustainable Tourism Plan for Barcelona

Ioannis Kapetanakis
THE6003 Sustainable Tourism Management
Assessment 2: Oral Presentation

2. Presentation Roadmap

The presentation moves from evidence to stakeholder governance.



3. Executive Diagnosis: A Measured but Exposed Destination

Barcelona has advanced tourism monitoring, but pressure remains spatially concentrated and politically sensitive.

Mature Tourism Governance

Policy & Monitoring Capacity: Advanced

Neighbourhood Pressure Hotspot

Spatially Concentrated Exposure

TPI Maximum Score:

100

Second-Highest TPI:

55.9

Sharp hotspot gap

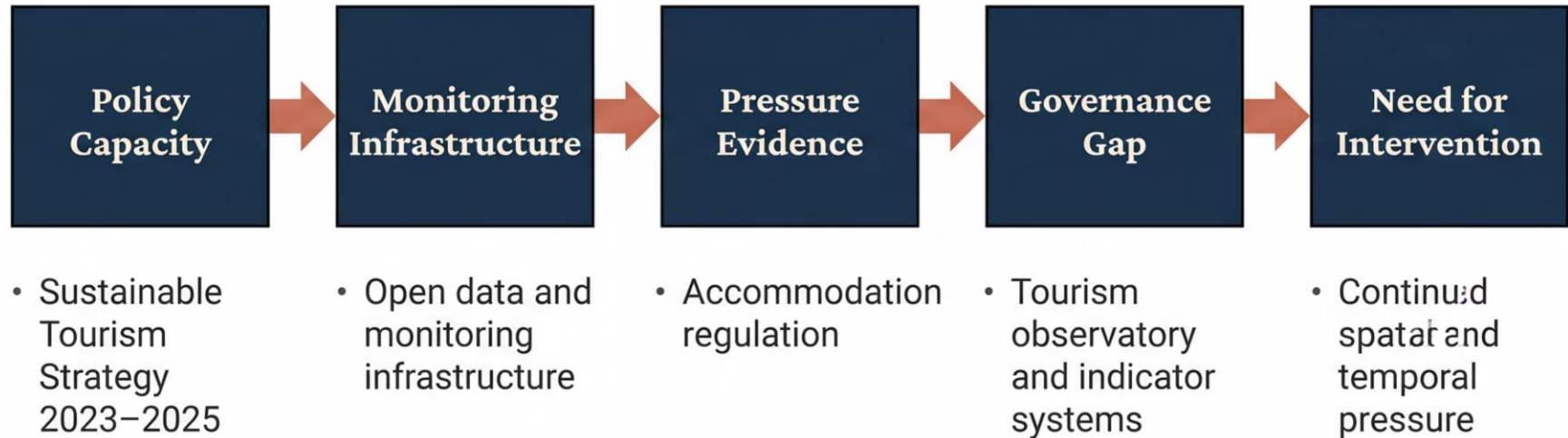
Platform & Port Pressure

Accommodation & Seasonal Peaks

- Strong tourism policy capacity
- Uneven neighbourhood exposure
- Accommodation/platform pressure
- Accommodation/platform
- Seasonal visitor-flow peaks
- Need for pressure-sensitive governance

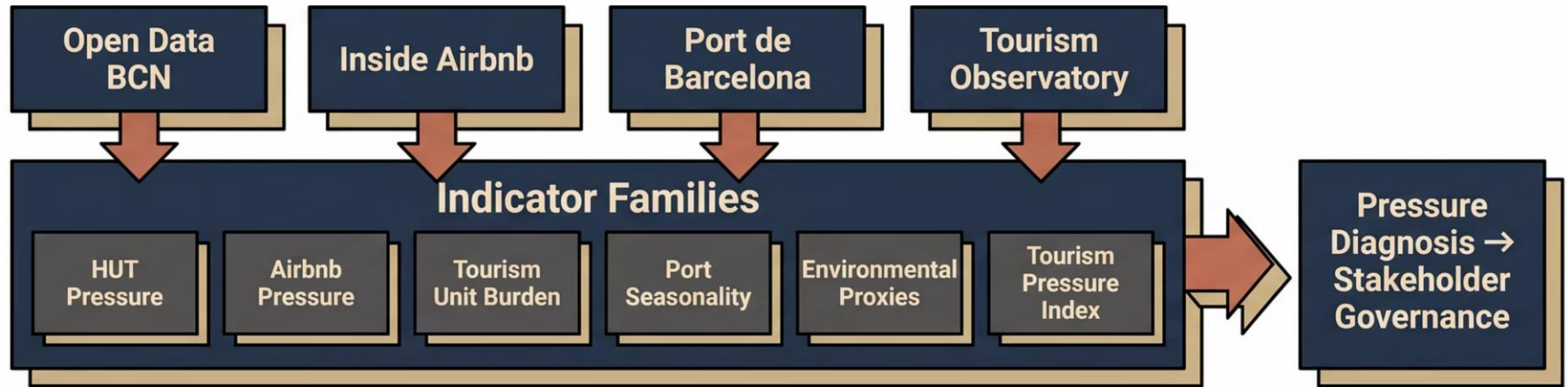
4. Barcelona Is Not an Unmanaged Destination

The issue is not absence of policy; it is the gap between policy capacity and pressure reduction.



5. Evidence Base: From Datasets to Pressure Indicators

The analysis combines open tourism, accommodation, port and urban datasets to identify where stakeholder participation should be prioritised.

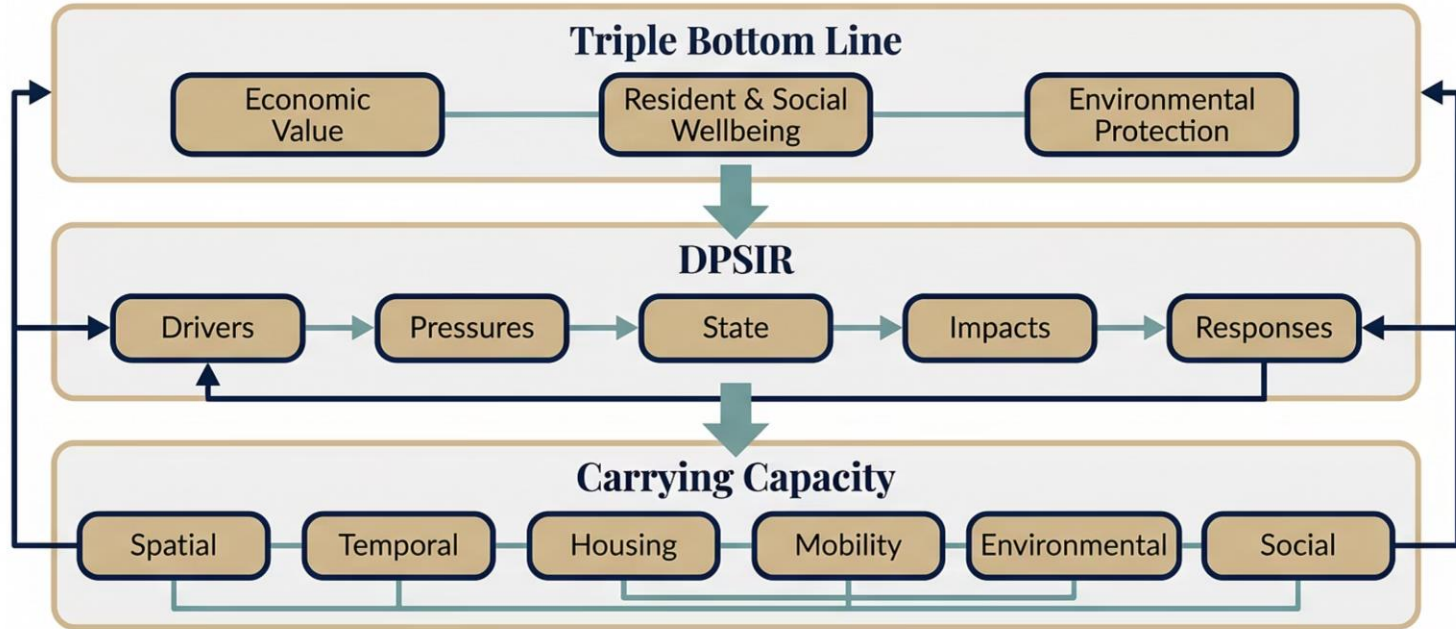


- Barcelona Open Data BCN
- Inside Airbnb
- Port de Barcelona

- Tourism Observatory
- Neighbourhood and district indicators

6. Analytical Lens: Sustainability as a Pressure System

Barcelona's tourism challenge is best understood as a multi-pressure system, not a single visitor-number problem.

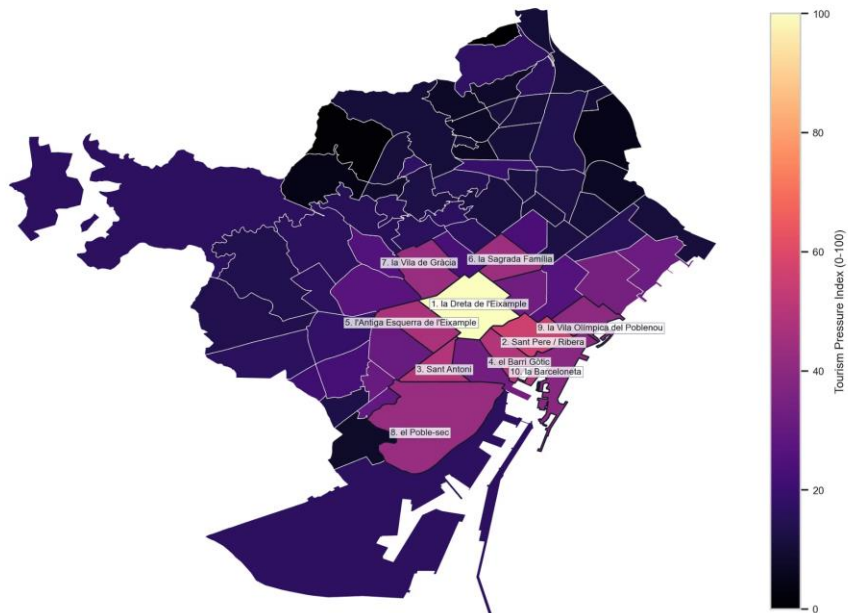


- Success cannot be judged by volume alone
- Pressure is spatial and temporal
- Policy must be evaluated through indicators
- Participation should reflect exposure

7. Spatial Pressure: Citywide Averages Hide Local Stress

Tourism pressure is concentrated at neighbourhood level.

Detailed Barcelona hotspot map: Tourism Pressure Index



Geographically
Uneven

Pressure does not distribute
evenly across the city

Central Areas
Overloaded

Core neighbourhoods carry
disproportionate stress

Local Exposure, Local
Voice

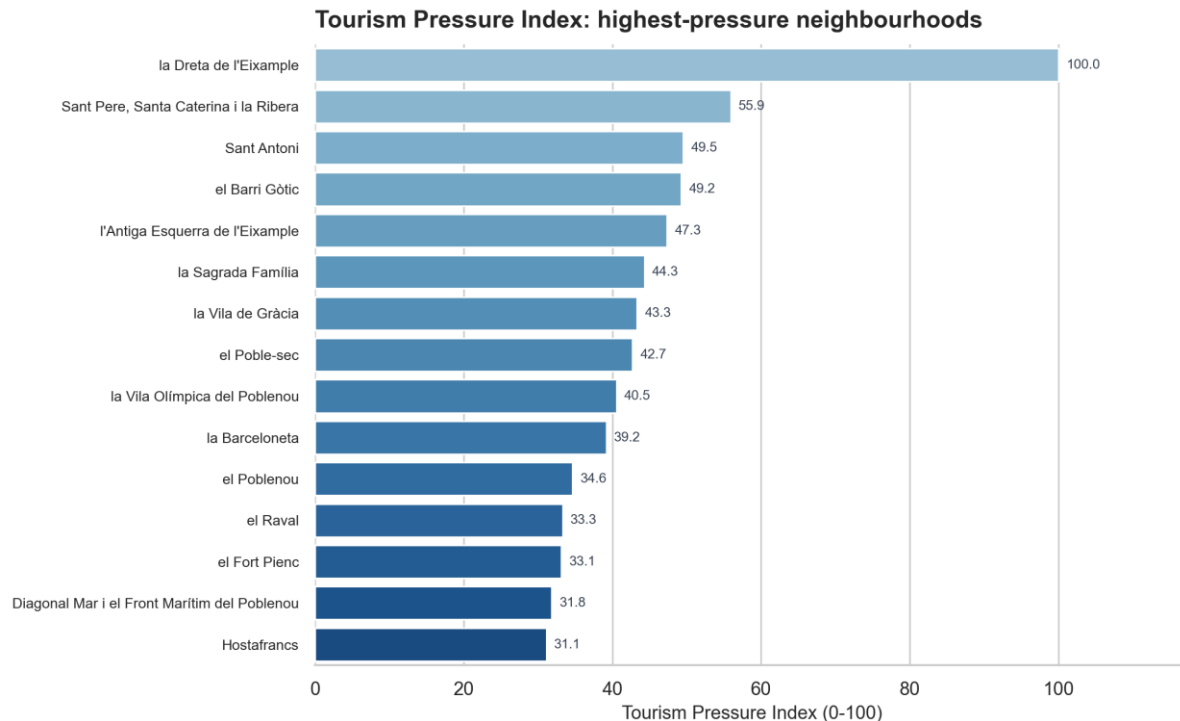
High-pressure areas should
trigger local participation rights

Hotspots Need
Targeted Governance

Citywide averages mask where
intervention is needed

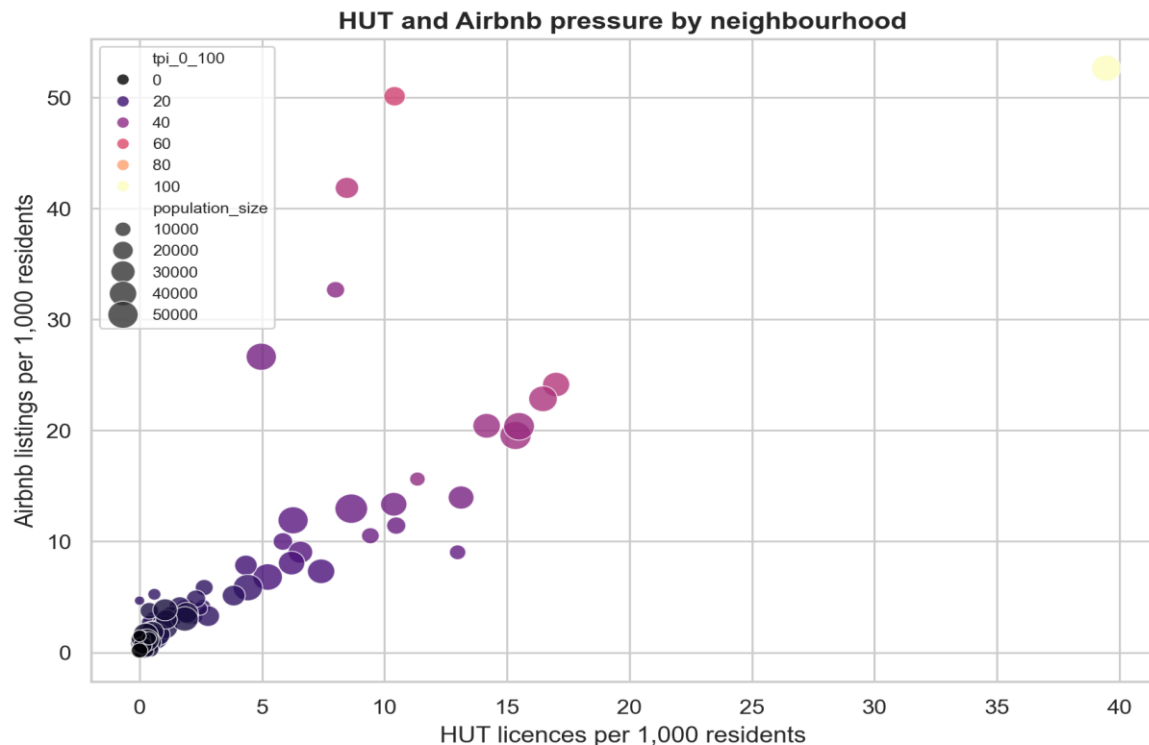
8. TPI Ranking: The Hotspot Structure Is Uneven

La Dreta de l'Eixample is structurally dominant in the Tourism Pressure Index.



- TPI maximum score: 100
- Second-highest score: 55.9
- Sharp pressure concentration – not a gradual distribution
- Supports threshold-based neighbourhood intervention

9. Accommodation Pressure: Licensed Supply and Platform Supply Overlap



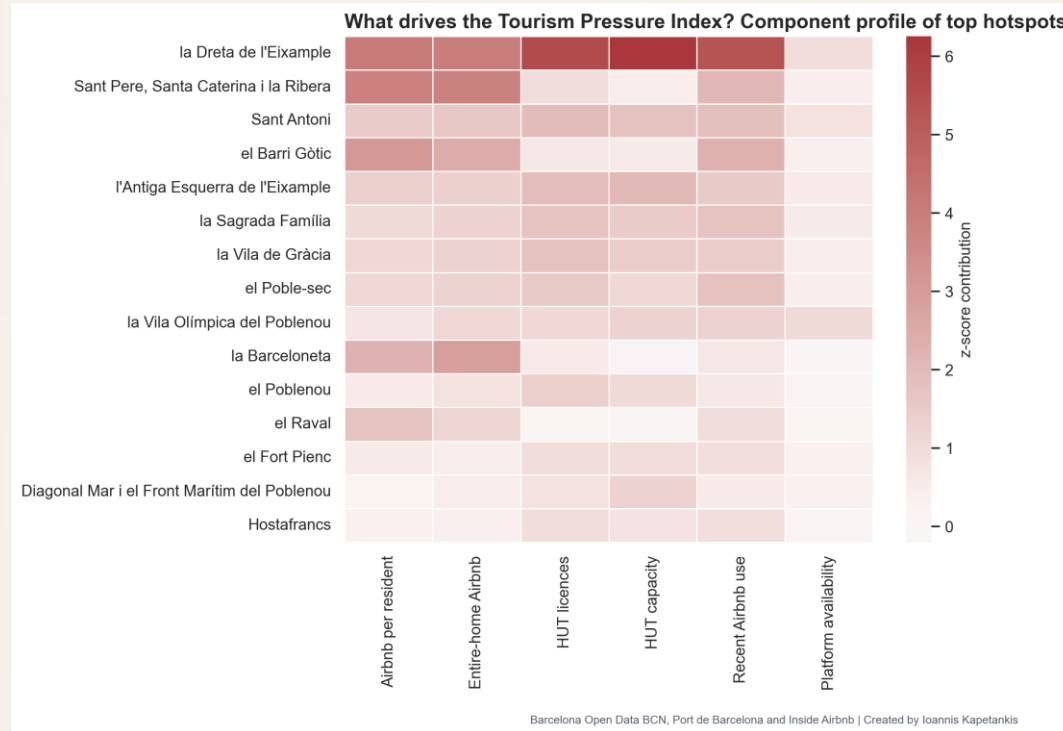
created by Ioannis Kapetankis

Governance Implication

- HUTs: regulated tourist housing pressure
- Airbnb: platform-mediated supply pressure
- Overlap areas create enforcement complexity
- Outlier neighbourhoods need differentiated policy responses

10. Spatial Inequality: Who Carries the Tourism Burden?

Tourism accommodation pressure is spatially uneven: several districts carry a larger share of tourism units than their share of Barcelona's resident population.



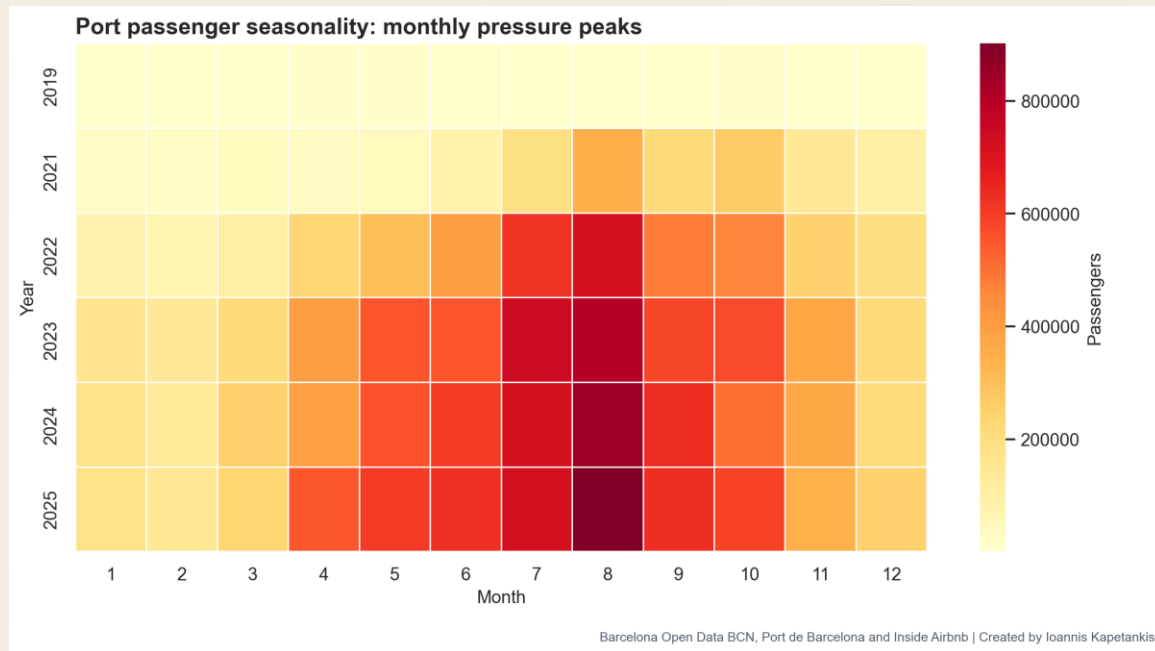
Stakeholder Consequence

Districts with surplus tourism accommodation pressure should receive stronger formal representation in destination-governance decisions.

- Eixample and Ciutat Vella show surplus tourism pressure
- Several districts remain primarily residential in exposure profile
- Citywide averages conceal unequal local impacts
- Participation weight should reflect measurable burden, not only administrative equality

11. Temporal Pressure: Cruise and Port Peaks Matter

Tourism pressure is temporal as well as spatial: peak-month surges intensify destination stress far beyond what annual averages suggest.



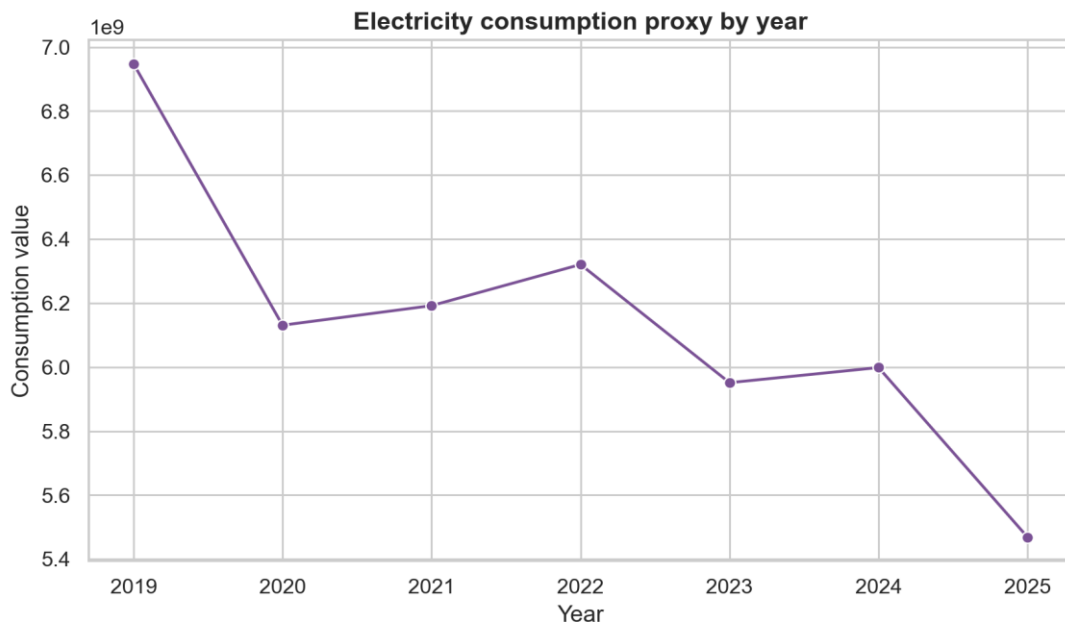
Monthly port and cruise seasonality heatmap — passenger flow intensity by month.

- Peak months amplify operational and mobility pressure
- Annual averages conceal short-duration overtourism episodes
- Cruise arrivals intensify pressure on public space and urban transit
- Port scheduling should be treated as a destination-governance variable

Temporal concentration matters because short peak periods can generate disproportionate infrastructure and liveability stress.

12. Environmental Proxies: Useful but Not Causal Proof

Electricity and air-quality data support monitoring, but require cautious interpretation.



created by Ioannis Kapetankis

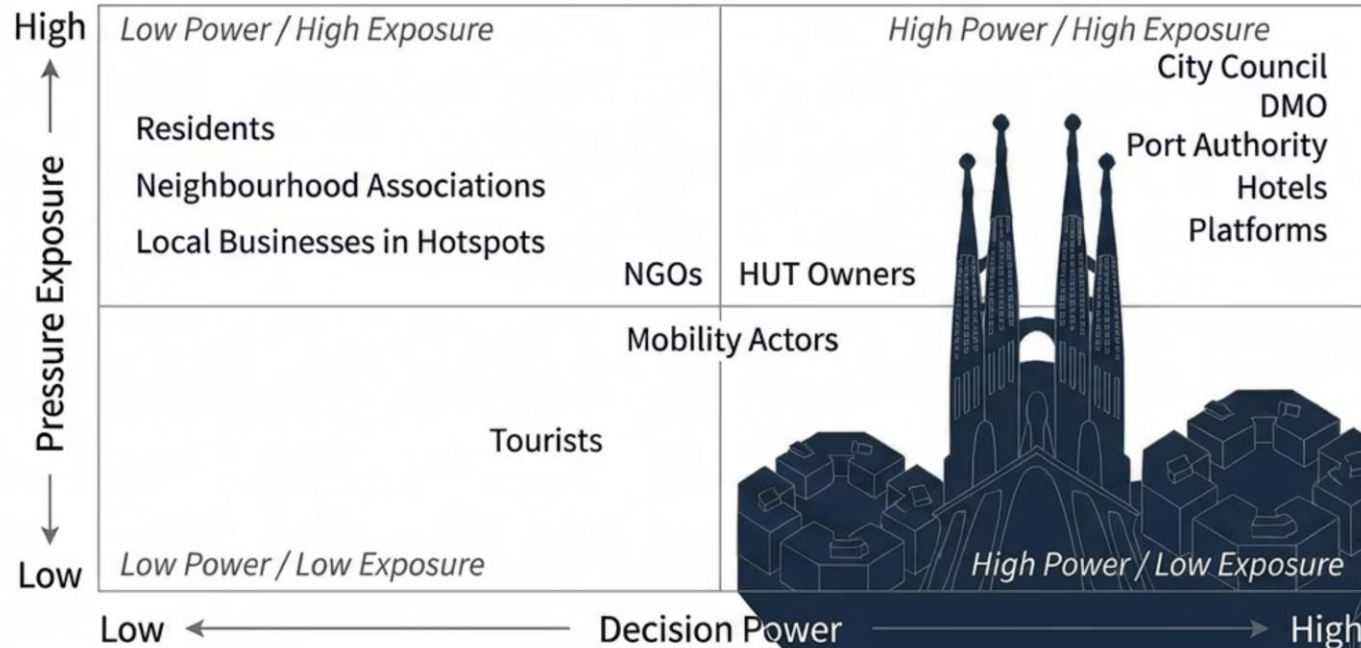
Analytical Caution

Proxy ≠ proof of direct tourism causality

- Environmental monitoring coverage is uneven across districts
- Electricity consumption trends have multiple explanations
- Tourism causality cannot be directly assumed from proxies
- Improved local monitoring is required for robust analysis

13. Stakeholder Map: Power and Exposure Are Misaligned

The most exposed stakeholders are not always the most powerful decision-makers.



- Power shapes policy agenda
- Exposure shapes lived impact

- Residents need stronger formal voice
- Data can rebalance participation rights

14. Stakeholder Conflict: Value, Liveability and Limits

Barcelona's governance problem is a conflict between tourism value, resident liveability and urban carrying capacity

	Airbnb/Platform Growth	Cruise/Day-Visitor Pressure	Informal Accommodation Competition	Growth vs Management Trade-off	High-Volume Tourism
Residents					
Hotels					
City Council					
DMO					
NGOs / Community Groups					
Local Businesses					

- Conflicts reflect unequal exposure, not misunderstanding
- Generic consultation cannot resolve structural imbalances
- Decision rules must be pressure-sensitive and transparent
- Conflict mapping must inform governance design

15. Participation Gap: Consultation Is Not Enough

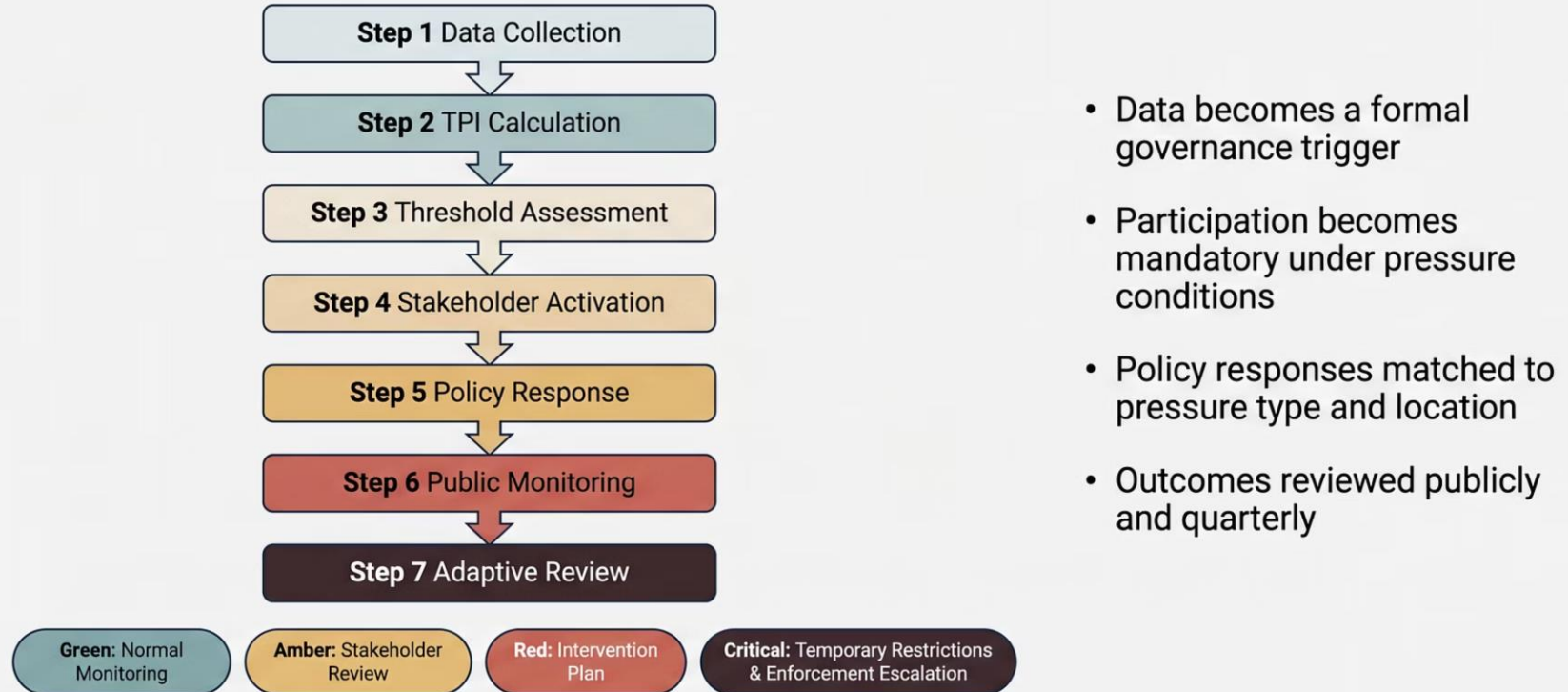
Stakeholder participation must be linked to exposure, indicators and decision rights.

Stakeholder	Main Interest	Exposure	Current Influence	Missing Mechanism	Indicator Trigger
Residents	Housing & liveability	High	Low	Resident pressure panels	TPI threshold
Neighbourhood Associations	Local enforcement	High	Low-Medium	Neighbourhood TPI hearings	TPI threshold
Hotels	Occupancy & fair competition	Medium	High	Destination quality reviews	Platform audit results
HUT Owners	Licence value & stability	Medium	Medium	Regulatory consultation forum	HUT pressure score
Platforms/Airbnb	Supply flexibility	Medium	High	Platform-data audit forum	Airbnb listings ratio
Port Authority	Passenger volume	Medium	High	Port peak-pressure working group	Peak-to-average ratio
Local Businesses	Footfall & survival	Medium	Low-Medium	Local business transition fund	TPI and footfall
NGOs	Accountability	Medium	Low	Monitoring seat on council	Enforcement actions
DMO	Competitiveness	High	High	Marketing-pressure review	TPI and pressure levels
City Council	Regulation & legitimacy	Medium	Very High	Mandatory review triggers	Composite TPI

- Influence is currently uneven across stakeholder groups
- Exposed groups require earlier and formalised involvement
- Indicator triggers create accountability and transparency
- Participation must demonstrably affect decisions

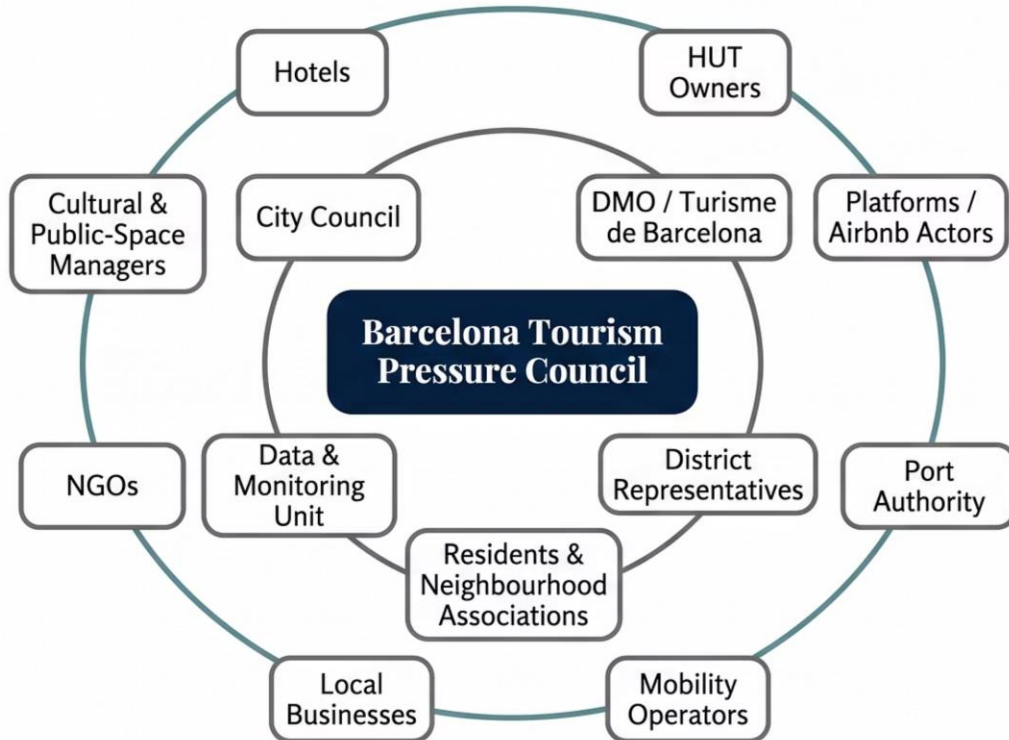
16. Proposed Model: TPI-Triggered Stakeholder Governance

Barcelona should convert pressure indicators into formal stakeholder action



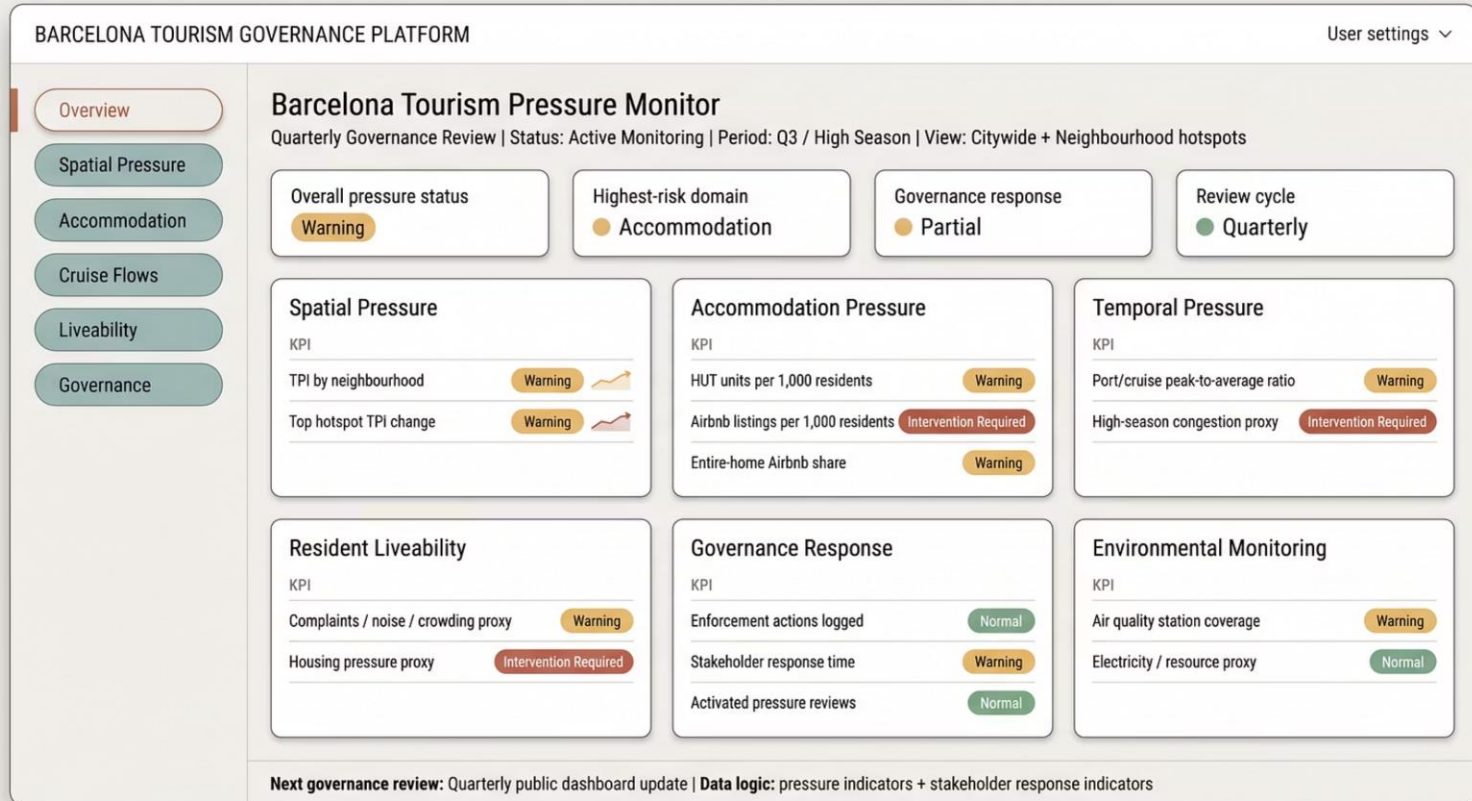
17. Proposed Institution: Barcelona Tourism Pressure Council

A dedicated council can formalise cross-stakeholder coordination and reduce fragmented governance.



Validate pressure indicators
Review and set thresholds
Trigger stakeholder consultations
Recommend policy actions
Monitor implementation
Publish accountability dashboard

- Formal voice for high-exposure areas
- Shared responsibility across all sectors
- Transparent and auditable pressure thresholds
- Better alignment between policy language and lived impact



- Track pressure and governance response together
- Separate tourism volume from tourism impact
- Make governance fully auditable
- Review dashboard publicly every quarter

19. Strategic Shift: From Tourism Volume to Net Destination Performance

Strong tourism performance should be judged not only by gross tourism activity, but by the net value created for the destination after accounting for pressure, concentration and liveability costs.

Traditional metrics → Adjusted evaluation → Better destination performance

Traditional Tourism Performance Logic

Measures gross tourism activity

- Arrivals volume
- Hotel occupancy
- Visitor spending
- Revenue growth
- Tourism tax generation
- Demand expansion

Useful, but incomplete as destination success measures.

Net Destination Performance Logic

Evaluates value after destination costs and pressures are considered

Net Destination Performance =

Positive value drivers

- + Tourism economic contribution
- + Local value retention
- + Employment and business support
- + Cultural contribution
- + Fiscal contribution

Adjustment factors / destination costs

- Spatial pressure concentration
- Housing and accommodation pressure
- Seasonal peak intensity
- Resident liveability loss
- Public-space and infrastructure stress
- Environmental management burden

A stronger destination performance model recognises both value creation and destination cost.

Pressure-Adjusted Destination Value

Measures sustainable and resilient destination performance

- Higher retained local value
- Better resident acceptance
- Stronger quality of place
- More balanced spatial distribution
- Lower peak-period stress
- More resilient tourism economy
- Improved long-term competitiveness

Success is defined by balanced value creation, not volume alone.

- Move beyond gross volume as the main indicator of success

- Evaluate tourism through value creation and destination costs together

- Reward more dispersed, lower-pressure and higher-quality tourism activity

- Embed pressure-adjusted KPIs into destination reporting and governance review

Management implication: A destination can increase tourism activity while reducing net destination performance if local pressure rises faster than local value.

12A. The Cost of Delay: Why Barcelona Must Act Now

Without timely intervention, Barcelona risks deeper socio-economic strain, resident backlash, cultural erosion and a weakening of tourism's social legitimacy.



Resident anti-tourism protests in Barcelona illustrate the growing social cost of unmanaged tourism pressure.

Management Implication

Visible resident protests indicate that tourism pressure is no longer only a planning issue; it is becoming a governance, legitimacy and destination-resilience issue.

- Delayed action increases the risk of **social and political backlash**
- Resident hostility signals declining tolerance for concentrated tourism pressure
- **Cultural identity and neighbourhood liveability** may be weakened by unmanaged visitor concentration
- Failure to intervene may **damage Barcelona's social licence to operate as a high-volume urban destination**

Immediate action is not only a sustainability priority; it is a risk-management necessity.

20. Selected References

Evidence base and academic grounding – Harvard format.

Ajuntament de Barcelona (2016–2024) datasets and policy documents
[opendata-ajuntament.barcelona.cat / bcncroc] / Barcelona Turisme
(2023) *Sustainable Tourism Strategy 2023–2025* [barcelonaturisme.com]
Inside Airbnb (2025) Barcelona dataset [insideairbnb.com]
Port de Barcelona (n.d.) Passenger traffic statistics
[opendata.portdebarcelona.cat]
Observatori del Turisme a Barcelona (2022, 2025, 2026) SITS system,
datasets and annual report [observatoriturisme.barcelona]
Gutiérrez et al. (2017) *Tourism Management*, 62, 278–291
García-López et al. (2020) *Journal of Urban Economics*, 119, 103278
Blanco-Romero et al. (2018) *Sustainability*, 10(6), 2043
Cocola-Gant (2016) *Sociological Research Online*, 21(3), 35–43

Milano et al. (2019) *Overtourism*. CABI
Milano, Novelli & Cheer (2019) *Tourism Planning & Development*, 16(4),
353–357 / Milano, Novelli & Russo (2024) *Tourism Geographies*, 26(8),
1313–1337 / Koens et al. (2018) *Sustainability*, 10(12), 4384
Dodds & Butler (2019) *Overtourism*. De Gruyter
Mason (2020) *Tourism Impacts, Planning and Management*. 4th ed.
Routledge
Hall, Gössling & Scott (2015) *Routledge Handbook of Tourism and
Sustainability*
Gyódi et al. (2025) *Cities*, 162, 105915
Bei (2025) *Cities*, 158, 105603
Russo & Scarnato (2018) *Journal of Urban Affairs*, 40(4), 455–474

Thank You

Questions and Discussion Welcome